

SAM SWANKE

skswanke@gmail.com · samswanke.com

New York, NY

SUMMARY

Engineering leader with 9+ years of experience building consumer products and distributed systems, including 4+ years managing high-performing teams across legal, financial, and insurance domains. Currently lead engineering at a \$10M+ annual-revenue legal technology company, with a track record of launching 0→1 products, modernizing critical platforms, and improving reliability, performance, security, and engineering velocity.

EXPERIENCE

HelloPrenup Chief Technology Officer

Dec 2024 – Present New York, NY

Built and led engineering at a growth-stage legal technology company generating \$10M+ in annual revenue, owning organization design, architecture, security, and delivery across multiple consumer legal products.

- Built the engineering organization from zero, hiring and onboarding 4 engineers and maintaining **100% team retention** through a high-pressure platform rebuild and second-product launch.
- Recovered an at-risk Postnup.com initiative and launched on schedule with a lean 3-person engineering team, using disciplined scope reduction, secure AI-assisted development, and staged UAT and rollout to deliver and stabilize a new consumer legal platform.
- Evolved the platform into reusable services and application components supporting multiple consumer legal products, reducing duplicated implementation across authentication, customer workflows, attorney operations, and shared infrastructure.
- Oversaw implementation of AI-assisted attorney tooling that improved attorney review times and increased operational leverage while preserving human oversight and controls for sensitive legal data.
- Established the security and governance foundation for **AI-enabled legal workflows**, proactively managing emerging risks as the company expanded its use of AI.
- Led a **zero-downtime migration** from a monolithic no-code platform to a stateless, horizontally scalable AWS architecture supporting 5–10K monthly active users and **12M+ monthly requests**, achieving **30ms average API latency and 130ms p99 latency**; contributed 30% of production code changes.
- Reduced customer support tickets by **44%** and page-load times by **61%** through architectural, reliability, and user-experience improvements.

Amazon Software Development Manager

May 2022 – Dec 2024 New York, NY

Led a team of 8 (5 direct-report SDEs, 1 Sr. SDE, 1 PM-T, 1 TPM) building large-scale, highly reliable internal platforms for Amazon Treasury's Global Risk Management & Claims organization, partnering with product, finance and claims teams.

- Took ownership of a mission-critical insurance request platform **4 weeks before launch** following external vendor (ProServe) handoff; drove cutover plan, reprioritized scope, and delivered a stable production launch.
- Led structured handover deep-dive: triaged 65 issues, delivered **47 launch-critical fixes**, including 33 bugs, 9 data-integrity gaps, and 5 configuration defects prior to go-live.
- Enabled procurement workflows supporting **nine-figure** insurance contracts by delivering a reliable, auditable system under aggressive deadlines.

- Designed and launched distributed case-management workflows supporting **over 750** nonprofit partners and **30,000** annual cases, using AWS-native services and event-driven orchestration.
- Improved engineering quality and operational readiness: raised unit test coverage from **5% → 40%**, introduced production readiness gates, and strengthened monitoring/alerting to reduce regressions.
- Reduced weekly on-call incidents by **50%** through improved test strategy, better operational processes, and targeted architectural simplification.
- Managed and mentored 5 engineers; coached **2** engineers through successful **L4→L5** promotions and expanded ownership across system areas.
- Navigated shifting org priorities (including deprioritization of a flagship product) while maintaining team morale, delivery predictability, and customer trust.

Amazon Software Development Engineer II

Aug 2021 – May 2022 New York, NY

- Led architecture and implementation of a greenfield distributed service using AWS-native infrastructure, designing scalable data models and workflows for complex business processes.
- Served as front-end technical lead and mentor, carved a pathway to promotion into engineering management.

Feather Senior Software Engineer

Dec 2019 – Jul 2021 New York, NY

- Led development of internal tools streamlining operational workflows and reducing manual overhead. Improved site performance through frontend optimizations, which reduced load times by **30%**.

CALA Software Engineer

Aug 2018 – Nov 2019 New York, NY

- Engineer #2 at a fashion technology startup; helped scale the engineering team and build core platform features supporting product design, production tracking, and fulfillment.

Dealer.com Software Engineer / Intern

May 2016 – Aug 2018 Burlington, VT

- Built data-processing libraries to canonicalize large-scale customer data and developed maintainable frontend applications in Java and Angular. Shared modern frontend best practices through internal technical talks.

Cosechando Felicidad Inc Front-End Engineer (Volunteer)

Aug 2015 – Present Remote

- Sole developer for HarvestingHappiness.org, supporting a nonprofit serving vulnerable communities through long-term volunteer engagement.

EDUCATION

University of Vermont

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, Minor in Mathematics

May 2017

TECHNICAL STRENGTHS

- **Engineering Leadership:** Incident management, on-call operations, hiring and onboarding, performance management, delivery planning, architecture and design
- **Infrastructure:** AWS (compute, storage, messaging, observability), CI/CD, infrastructure as code
- **Languages:** TypeScript / JavaScript, Java, Python, C++
- **Systems & Frameworks:** React, Node.js, API design, distributed systems
- **Data:** PostgreSQL, MySQL, DynamoDB